

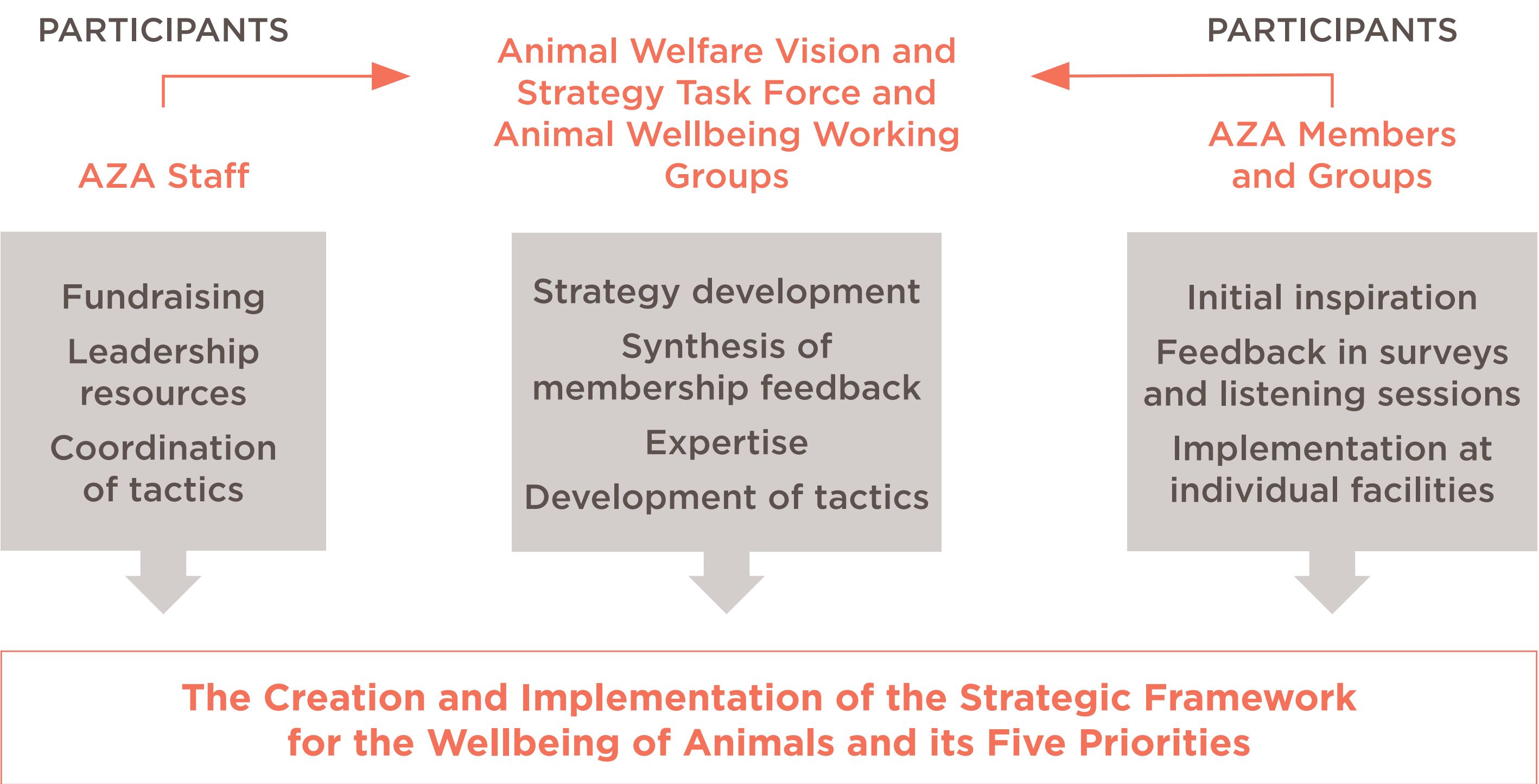
THE AZA STRATEGIC FRAMEWORK FOR THE WELLBEING OF ANIMALS

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AZA’s Position Statement on the Wellbeing of Animals

- Members of the Association of Zoos and Aquariums (AZA) believe that the wellbeing of the animals in our care is both our moral responsibility and foundational to AZA’s mission.
- To support this belief, AZA members commit their diverse expertise to continuously advance and share knowledge, tools, and actions that promote the wellbeing of animals.
- We aspire to be globally trusted leaders in enhancing the wellbeing of animals.

Who is Involved and How Do They Contribute?



Strategic Priority: Cultivate a Culture

Cultivate a common culture of commitment to the wellbeing of animals across all AZA facilities and partners.



Strategic Priority: Enhance Lives

Enhance the lives of all animals in our care by focusing on applied animal welfare science and science-based staff training and education.



Strategic Priority: Raise the Bar

Advance AZA accreditation standards and processes focused on the wellbeing of animals.



Strategic Priority: Build Partnerships

Increase and diversify external collaboration and find more common ground to promote the wellbeing of animals.



Strategic Priority: Further Credibility

Promote awareness of and trust in AZA's commitment to and expertise in enhancing the wellbeing of animals.

AZA’s Definition of Animal Wellbeing

A state of being comfortable, healthy, or happy; achieved by AZA facilities giving animals lifelong opportunities to thrive. Animal wellbeing in AZA facilities is supported through:

- Leadership, culture, and operations
- Science and innovation
- Expertise and passion
- Collaboration and sharing
- Engagement and communication
- Our approach to the conservation of species and natural spaces

Why Wellbeing Instead of Welfare?

- The word “welfare” has multiple meanings in public contexts.
- A common definition of welfare in the United States is help for the unemployed, sick, or animals who are suffering.
- The word “welfare” may have a negative connotation as it implies something needs to be corrected.
- The public more easily understands the word “wellbeing,” which allows for more effective communication.
- Animal welfare science is larger than the zoo and aquarium community; the use of “welfare” is still appropriate when referring to research.
- Animal welfare is the science that informs animal care to enhance wellbeing.

STRATEGIC FRAMEWORK FOR THE WELLBEING OF ANIMALS



To view the Wellbeing Strategy in its entirety, please scan this QR code.

The Importance of Culture

Culture is shared:

Language
Values and Beliefs
Rules and Expectations
Behavioral Norms and Practices

These tie a community together and guide collective actions.

Culture affects:

Staff behavior
Communication strategies
Priority setting
Decision-making
Spending models
Crisis management
So much more

We would like to acknowledge the hard work and dedication of the members of the Animal Welfare Vision and Strategy Task Force, who compiled AZA member input and developed the AZA Strategic Framework for the Wellbeing of Animals: Scott Terrell, DVM, Dipl ACVP (Disney Parks and Resorts); Robin Keith (Ecoleaders); Lisa New (Knoxville Zoo); Candice Dorsey, PhD (AZA); Stephanie Allard, PhD (National Aquarium); Caitlin Hadfield, MA, VetMB, MRCVS, DACZM, DECZM (Seattle Aquarium); Sharon Joseph, MBA (Birmingham Zoo); Randy Junge, DVM, DACZM, DACAW (Columbus Zoo); Dwight Lawson, PhD (Oklahoma City Zoo); Danielle Logue (Jenkinson's Aquarium); Jessica McAtee (National Aviary); Colleen McCann, PhD (WCS/Bronx Zoo); Lance Miller, PhD (Brookfield Zoo); David Powell, PhD (Saint Louis Zoo); Megan Ross, PhD (Lincoln Park Zoo); Mandi Schook, PhD (Disney Parks and Resorts); Jackie Wallace (Houston Zoo); Jason Watters, PhD (San Francisco Zoological Society); Jeff Wyatt, DVM, MPH, DACLAM (University of Rochester, Seneca Park Zoo).

How AZA is Creating a Culture of Animal Wellbeing

- Dedicating resources to support wellbeing initiatives
- Identifying the guiding principles that tie the AZA community together
- Actively communicating and reinforcing a unified culture
- Generating excitement around wellbeing efforts and successes of AZA members

How AZA is Enhancing the Lives of Animals

- Increasing accessibility to wellbeing-related resources
- Developing new wellbeing resources, and streamlining the process of developing Animal Care Manuals (ACMs) and Ambassador Animal Guidelines (AAGs)
- Promoting collaboration in research and science
- Creating new learning opportunities for staff across AZA
- Connecting with organizations that have shared goals
- Developing AZA's Animal Care and Wellbeing Fund grant program to support applied animal welfare science and staff training and education on animal wellbeing topics



To donate to the Animal Care and Wellbeing Grant Fund, please scan this QR code.